

Bohdan Leniuk

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Education

University of Georgia PhD in Economics Primary advisor: Martin Gervais	Athens, GA 2022–Present
University of Georgia MA in Economics	Athens, GA 2022–2023
University of Georgia BBA in Economics, Minor in Statistics	Athens, GA 2019–2022

Professional Experience

Data Scientist, State Farm (MAGNet Program)	Athens, GA 2021
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Research Interests

Macroeconomics; Labor Economics

Research & Teaching Experience

Graduate Research Assistant, University of Georgia

• Bill Lastrapes	2023
• Svetlana Pashchenko	2024
• Martin Gervais	2025–Present

Teaching Assistant, University of Georgia

• Intermediate Macroeconomics	2022–Present
• Microeconomic Theory I (PhD)	Fall 2024
• Microeconomic Theory II (PhD)	Spring 2024, Spring 2025
• Time Series Analysis (MS)	2022–2023

Instructor of Record, University of Georgia

• Principles of Macroeconomics	2025
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Honors & Awards

Scholarships:

• Edward T. Comer Scholarship, University of Georgia	2023–2025
• Bonbright Center for the Study of Regulation, University of Georgia	2022
• Zell B. Miller Scholarship	2019–2022

Awards & Recognitions:

- Best Second-Year Paper, University of Georgia
- Deans List, University of Georgia
- AP Scholar with Distinction

2024
2019-2022
2019

Technical Skills

R , Python, MATLAB, Stata

Working Papers

1. “Promotions, Unemployment, and Labor-Market Sorting Under Asymmetric Information,”

This paper studies how promotions and unemployment shape labor-market sorting and wages. Using the 1979 National Longitudinal Survey of Youth (NLSY79), I show that promotions amplify the wage losses associated with unemployment spells: previously promoted workers experience larger wage losses upon re-employment, and those losses increase as the spell prolongs, even conditional on pre-displacement wage and tenure. I interpret these facts through a structural model of promotions and job search in which firms learn about worker ability from a worker’s history of promotions and unemployment spells. When hiring a worker out of unemployment, firms use this information to assign him a position. Because unemployment duration is a noisy signal of ability, the model implies that unemployment can serve as a shock to labor-market sorting through which firms may either correct an erroneous promotion or incorrectly move capable workers back down the job-ladder. Because UI benefits alter search behavior, they also change how much an unemployment spell reveals about a worker. Relative to a flat benefit profile, UI plans that tie benefits to past wages worsen sorting and lower aggregate output, while policies that target benefits toward low-ability workers improve sorting and raise output.

Work in Progress

1. “Pension Plan Design and Worker Mobility: Evidence from LEHD, Form 5500, and Summary Plan Descriptions” with Martin Gervais.

Conference Presentations

2026: I-85 Macro Workshop, Columbia, SC; Vienna Macro Workshop, Vienna, Austria

References

Martin Gervais mgervaisca@gmail.com	University of Georgia
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Svetlana Pashchenko svetlana@uga.edu	University of Georgia